SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #8 · RACE, ETHNICITY AND LANGUAGE

# “Because of my background, I'll always be an outsider.”

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## Where it often comes from

Accent, skin color, immigration history, religion, or a different way of speaking or eating can set us apart. Repeated questions like “Where are you really from?” or being left out of social circles reinforce a sense of not belonging. We may start to pull back before others can exclude us.

## What Scripture teaches

Paul writes, “There is neither Jew nor Greek, slave nor free, male nor female, for you are all one in Christ Jesus,” and “You are no longer strangers and foreigners, but fellow citizens with the saints and members of God’s household.” John saw “a multitude too large to count, from every nation and tribe and people and tongue, standing before the throne.” Ruth, a foreigner, said, “Your people will be my people, and your God will be my God,” and was welcomed into Israel’s story. In Christ, background becomes a gift in a family that includes every nation, not a barrier.

> *“Therefore you are no longer strangers and foreigners, but fellow citizens with the saints and members of God’s household”* (Ephesians 2:19).

## Also see

> “There is neither Jew nor Greek, slave nor free, male nor female, for you are all one in Christ Jesus” (Galatians 3:28).

> “After this I looked and saw a multitude too large to count, from every nation and tribe and people and tongue, standing before the throne and before the Lamb. They were wearing white robes and holding palm branches in their hands” (Revelation 7:9).

> “But Ruth replied: ‘Do not urge me to leave you or to turn from following you. For wherever you go, I will go, and wherever you live, I will live; your people will be my people, and your God will be my God.’” (Ruth 1:16).

> “God settles the lonely in families; He leads the prisoners out to prosperity, but the rebellious dwell in a sun-scorched land” (Psalm 68:6).

## Common self-statements

- I will never fully belong here.
- They will always see me as different.
- I am too foreign.
- There is nowhere I fit.
- I have to hide where I am from.
- Others have a place and I do not.

## Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting permanent exclusion.
- Overgeneralizing: Treating some rejections as universal.
- Labeling: Calling myself “an outsider.”
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling excluded and concluding that I always will be.

## Challenging questions

- When have I felt welcomed, even for a moment?
- What would belonging, not sameness, look like for me?
- What do I bring from my background that enriches others?
- What does Scripture say about every nation worshiping together?
- Where might I find communities that welcome people from many backgrounds?
- What is one step toward connection?

## Truth summary

> In Christ I belong to a family that includes every nation and tongue. My background is part of who I am, not a reason to be excluded. I can seek welcoming communities and share what I bring.

## Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Prejudice
- Loneliness
- Church
- Friendship
- Citizenship

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

## Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

## Songs that speak truth to this belief

If We Are the Body — Casting Crowns
The church is called to welcome and care for people rather than exclude or shame them.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

Softly and Tenderly — Kristyn Getty with Vince Gill, Ellie Holcomb and Sierra Hull
This older hymn pictures Christ's gracious invitation to return rather than hide in shame.

*Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"*

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

# My Plan for Replacing "Because of my background, I'll always be an outsider"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

## 1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

*Rate it now so you can see your progress later.*

"Because of my background, I'll always be an outsider." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

## 2 My best question

*The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.*

- ☐ When did I feel welcome?
- ☐ What do I bring?
- ☐ What does belonging look like?
- ☐ Where can I find welcome?
- ☐ Whom can I welcome?
- ☐ What is my next step?

My own question: _____

## 3 My replacement truth

*The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.*

- ☐ I am a fellow citizen and member of God's household.
- ☐ There is one family in Christ.
- ☐ Every nation will stand before the throne.
- ☐ My background is a gift.
- ☐ God settles the lonely in families.
- ☐ I can seek and build belonging.

In my own words: _____

## 4 My Scripture

*The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.*

- ☐ Ephesians 2:19
  *"Therefore you are no longer strangers and foreigners, but fellow citizens with the saints and members of God's household."*
- ☐ Galatians 3:28
  *"There is neither Jew nor Greek, slave nor free, male nor female, for you are all one in Christ Jesus."*
- ☐ Revelation 7:9
  *"After this I looked and saw a multitude too large to count, from every nation and tribe and people and tongue, standing before the throne and before the Lamb. They were wearing white robes and holding palm branches in their hands."*

A verse I found myself: _____

# Practicing the Truth

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## 5 My practice plan

*Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.*

### EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

### PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] A welcome received: Each week, note one welcome you received or offered.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  *For example, Ephesians 2:19 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I am a fellow citizen and a member of God's household.""*
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Prejudice" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

## 6 My action step this week

*Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.*

*Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.*

- [ ] Name the moments. Write when you felt excluded and when you felt welcome.
- [ ] Share your story. Tell someone about your culture or background.
- [ ] Find a welcoming group. Visit a church or group with diverse members.
- [ ] Welcome someone else. Invite a newcomer.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

## 7 End-of-week check-in

*Bring this page to your next session.*

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Because of my background, I'll always be an outsider": _____ %  My truth: _____ %

## Daily practice tracker

| Day | Read my card | Said my verse | Used my reminder | A welcome |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | | | | |
| Tue | | | | |
| Wed | | | | |
| Thu | | | | |
| Fri | | | | |
| Sat | | | | |
| Sun | | | | |

## My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

| Day | Song I listened to | What it told me that challenges the lie |
|---|---|---|
| Mon | | |
| Tue | | |
| Wed | | |
| Thu | | |
| Fri | | |
| Sat | | |
| Sun | | |

## My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Because of my background, I'll always be an outsider.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

*Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.*

## Prayer

*Lord, You gather people from every nation. Make me at home in Your family, heal the sting of being excluded, and let me welcome others. Amen.*

*Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.*